

PUNJAB ORIGIN — AMRITSAR

Aloo Paratha

Spiced Potato-Stuffed Flatbread
Punjab's Quintessential Breakfast

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Aloo Paratha

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Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Breakfast That Built Amritsar's Food Culture

If one dish defines Punjabi breakfast, it's aloo paratha — a whole wheat flatbread stuffed generously with spiced mashed potato, pan-fried in ghee until golden and crisp. Its heartland is Amritsar, where entire streets and generations-old eateries have built their reputation on this single dish, and "Amritsari aloo paratha" is now recognized as its own celebrated style, distinct for its generous, well-seasoned filling.

The dish's popularity is rooted in practicality as much as flavor. Punjab's agricultural economy has long demanded a hearty, energy-dense breakfast to fuel a full day of physical farm work, and a potato-stuffed, ghee-fried bread fits that need perfectly — filling, satisfying, and rich enough to sustain hours of labor. That same heartiness has made it equally beloved among city dwellers and, eventually, the wider world.

Today, aloo paratha has traveled far beyond Punjab, becoming one of the most widely recognized North Indian breakfast dishes internationally, served in Indian restaurants and diaspora households from London to Toronto to Melbourne — usually still finished, as tradition demands, with a generous pat of butter and a side of cool yogurt.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Breakfast That Built Amritsar's Food Culture, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

The signature dish of Amritsar, where it has its own celebrated regional style known for a generously spiced filling. A daily Punjabi breakfast staple, historically valued for its heartiness ahead of a day of physical farm labor. Traditionally served with white butter, plain yogurt, and pickle — rarely with a separate curry, since the filling itself is well-seasoned. Now one of the most internationally recognized North Indian breakfast dishes, popular across the Indian diaspora worldwide.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

25m	20m	25m	4
ACTIVE PREP	DOUGH REST	COOK TIME	SERVINGS (5 PARATHAS)

Med
DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Mixing bowl for the dough
- Separate bowl for the potato filling
- Potato masher or fork
- Rolling pin
- Heavy tava or cast-iron skillet
- Basting brush or spoon for ghee

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Dough and filling can each be prepared up to a day ahead and refrigerated separately — assemble and cook fresh for the best texture. Cooked aloo parathas keep refrigerated for 2 days; reheat on a dry tava with a little ghee to restore crispness. They also freeze well, uncooked, stacked with parchment between each — cook directly from frozen, adding a minute or two to the cook time.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dough

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Whole wheat flour (atta)	2 cups	250 g	2 katori
Water, warm	¾ cup approx.	180 ml approx.	¾ katori approx.
Salt	½ tsp	3 g	to taste
Oil	1 tbsp	15 ml	1 chammach

For the potato filling

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Potatoes, boiled and peeled	3 medium	400 g	3 medium
Green chili, finely chopped	1–2	1–2	1–2
Fresh ginger, minced	1 tsp	5 g	1 chammach
Fresh coriander, chopped	3 tbsp	12 g	3 tbsp
Carom seeds (ajwain)	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Red chili powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Garam masala	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Dried mango powder (amchur)	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Salt	¾ tsp	4.5 g	to taste

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

For cooking

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Ghee or butter	4 tbsp	60 g	4 chammach

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Amchur (dried mango powder) adds a distinctive tang that's hard to substitute exactly, but a squeeze of lemon juice mixed into the filling works as a reasonable stand-in if unavailable. Garam masala blends vary by brand and household — any good quality store-bought version works fine, and quantities can be adjusted to taste. This recipe uses widely available vegetables and pantry spices, making it one of the more accessible dishes in this collection for cooks anywhere.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

The Dough and the Filling

01 MAKE THE DOUGH

Combine the whole wheat flour and salt, add the oil, and gradually mix in warm water, kneading for 6–8 minutes until smooth and soft. Cover and rest for at least 20 minutes.

02 PREPARE THE FILLING

Mash the boiled potatoes with a fork or masher until mostly smooth, with a few small chunks remaining for texture. Mix in the green chili, ginger, coriander, and all the spices, tasting and adjusting salt and heat to your preference.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

The Dough and the Filling, continued



Chef tip. make sure the filling is well-seasoned and slightly drier than you'd think necessary — a wet filling makes the paratha difficult to roll without tearing.

COOKING CHECKPOINT

The filling should hold together when pressed into a ball, without releasing excess moisture — if it feels wet, let it sit uncovered for a few minutes to dry slightly.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Stuffing & Cooking

03 STUFF THE DOUGH

Divide the dough into 5 balls. Flatten each into a small disc, place a generous portion of filling in the center, then gather the edges up and around the filling, pinching to seal completely into a ball.

04 ROLL GENTLY

Dust with flour and roll out gently and evenly, applying light pressure to avoid tearing and exposing the filling — go slowly, rotating as you roll, aiming for about ¼ inch / 6 mm thick.



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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Stuffing & Cooking, continued

05 COOK WITH GHEE

Heat a tava until hot. Cook the paratha for about a minute, then flip and add ghee around the edges. Continue flipping and adding ghee as needed, cooking until both sides are golden-brown with crisp spots, about 4–5 minutes total.

Color indicator. aloo paratha is ready when both sides show deep golden-brown patches and the edges look crisp rather than pale and soft.

06 PRESS FOR EVEN COOKING

Press gently all over with a spatula as it cooks, which helps the filling heat through evenly and encourages good browning across the whole surface.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Overstuffing the paratha or rolling too aggressively are the two most common causes of filling bursting through the dough. Use a moderate amount of filling and roll with slow, even, gentle pressure.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served hot with a generous pat of white butter melting on top, plain yogurt, and mango pickle.
- The quintessential Punjabi breakfast plate, often alongside a glass of sweet lassi or a cup of masala chai.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Restaurant Presentation

- Served in wedges with small bowls of yogurt, pickle, and butter on the side.

Family Style

- Cooked to order and served one at a time straight from the tava, so each person gets theirs piping hot.

Modern Pairing

- Works well as a hearty, portable breakfast wrap with just yogurt, no plate required.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Filling Right

- A well-seasoned, slightly dry filling is the key to a paratha that rolls smoothly without tearing.
- A few visible potato chunks, rather than a completely smooth mash, give the filling better texture.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Both dough and filling can be made the night before and assembled fresh in the morning for a quicker breakfast.
- Stuffed, uncooked parathas freeze exceptionally well — a genuinely practical make-ahead breakfast for busy weeks.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Amritsari dhabas are famous for their generous use of ghee, both in cooking and as a final baste — don't hold back if you want that authentic, indulgent street-food flavor.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

310 kcal	7 g	44 g	11 g	5 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with fat used and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Amritsari Aloo Paratha	an extra-generously stuffed, extra-spiced version, the signature style of Amritsar's famous paratha eateries.
Paneer Paratha	a popular cousin, filled with spiced crumbled paneer instead of potato.
Gobi Paratha	filled with finely grated, spiced cauliflower.
Mixed Vegetable Paratha	a modern variation combining potato with grated carrot and peas.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Why does my filling keep bursting out?

Usually overstuffing or rolling too hard. Use a moderate amount of filling, seal the dough completely, and roll with slow, gentle, even pressure.

Can I make the filling less spicy?

Yes — simply reduce or omit the green chili and red chili powder; the other spices provide plenty of flavor on their own.

Can I freeze these for later?

Yes — stuff and roll the parathas, then freeze uncooked between sheets of parchment. Cook directly from frozen, adding a minute or two extra per side.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Aloo	Hindi for potato, the defining filling of this dish.
Amchur	dried mango powder, used for a distinctive tangy note in the filling.
Ajwain	carom seeds, a small aromatic seed used in the filling and sometimes the dough.
Makhan	fresh, unsalted white butter, the traditional topping for this dish.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Aloo Paratha

25m	20m
ACTIVE PREP	DOUGH REST
25m	**4**
COOK TIME	SERVINGS (5 PARATHAS)
Med	
DIFFICULTY	

DOUGH

Whole wheat flour	250 g
Water	180 ml approx.
Salt	3 g
Oil	15 ml

POTATO FILLING

Potatoes	400 g
Green chili	1–2
Fresh ginger	5 g
Fresh coriander	12 g
Carom seeds	1.5 g
Red chili powder	1.5 g
Garam masala	1.5 g
Dried mango powder	1.5 g
Salt	4.5 g

FOR COOKING

Ghee or butter	60 g

METHOD

01 **Make the dough.** Combine the whole wheat flour and salt, add the oil, and gradually mix in warm water, kneading for 6–8 minutes until smooth and soft.

02 **Prepare the filling.** Mash the boiled potatoes with a fork or masher until mostly smooth, with a few small chunks remaining for texture.

03 **Stuff the dough.** Divide the dough into 5 balls.

04 **Roll gently.** Dust with flour and roll out gently and evenly, applying light pressure to avoid tearing and exposing the filling — go slowly, rotating as you roll, aiming for about ¼ inch / 6 mm thick.

05 **Cook with ghee.** Heat a tava until hot.

06 **Press for even cooking.** Press gently all over with a spatula as it cooks, which helps the filling heat through evenly and encourages good browning across the whole surface.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Whole wheat flour	250 g	☐ Salt	see recipe
☐ Oil	15 ml	☐ Potatoes	400 g
☐ Green chili	1–2	☐ Fresh ginger	5 g
☐ Fresh coriander	12 g	☐ Carom seeds	1.5 g
☐ Red chili powder	1.5 g	☐ Garam masala	1.5 g
☐ Dried mango powder	1.5 g	☐ Ghee or butter	60 g

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